

Community

This section showcases the achievements and writing contributions from our reader community.

Unwind

We take a look at the craziest memes to have emerged this year and put our own little spin on them.

When tech failed the year!

Every year has its fair share of fails, and 2016 didn't disappoint either!

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The world of technology can be awe inspiring in its glory. From devices that ooze brilliance to state of the art technology convincing us that the future is here, it might look like a big glittery scene to an observer. But someone once said that all that glitters is not gold, and they were definitely right about that for the technology world. Sometimes, all the brains and experience at the top tech companies all over the world cannot prevent a massive fail, that would seem pretty obvious in retrospect.

Well, after all the judgement calls are out and the numbers are debated, we are left with a list of fails this year that definitely remind you of what NOT to do as a tech company – whether you make smartphones or sell groceries!

Note 7

This will perhaps go down as one of the worst tech fails of the decade, if not of all time. Smartphone launches, especially from leading manufacturers, have become increasingly grand and hyped in recent times. The Note series from Samsung has seen favorable demand over the years and hence, when Samsung announced the Note 7 this year in August a lot of people wanted to get their hands on the device. But once the device started selling, that demand was turned on its head as several handsets of this model began exploding around the world. Samsung was quick to respond, but by the time they did, the damage was done. And when the relaunched replacement Note 7 devices also began exploding, the fate of the Note series was almost sealed. Samsung recalled all Note 7 devices and has put the Note

series on hold indefinitely. Well, when tech companies talked about explosive publicity, we're pretty sure they didn't mean it literally!

Macbook Pro

Apple has a thing about redesigning its devices. Of late, however, there appears to be a lack of logic when doing so. Some of you might really love the 2016 Macbook Pro, and there is nothing wrong with that. However, sometimes some things just defy common sense. The new Macbook Pro has killed all other connectivity ports in favor of Thunderbolt 3 via USB-C. So, no

digital AV adapter to be able to use an HDMI port along with a USB 3.0 port. A steal this one! And what if you just bought a brand new iPhone 7 Plus last month? Just \$25 to get a dongle to connect that.

Do you happen to have a Thunderbolt 2 device? There's a dongle for that (at \$50)! Got an SD card that you want to connect? A dongle for that (at \$50 again)! VGA? Dongle (\$50)! Gigabit Ethernet? Dongle (\$26)!

And if you've got older devices, Apple has already had a wide array of connectors available for you to make your world look like a tangled mess.



LeEco's audacious foray into self driving cars

HDMI, USB 3, Thunderbolt 2 and no connectivity for your iPhone either. If ever there was a design fail, it's got to be this one.

To add insult to injury, Apple has started a thriving dongle business. Want to connect anything that uses a regular USB port to your new Macbook? A pendrive perhaps, or a USB keyboard? You're going to need a USB-C to USB converter that sells for a mere \$19. Want to hook your macbook to a TV? Just \$70 and you can get the

LeEco runs out of cash

One look at Chinese manufacturer LeEco and you would think that they've expanded very quickly. You would be right. Perhaps a bit too right for LeEco's well-being. The company has made 11 smartphone models along with Smart TVs, Bluetooth speakers and has recently also forayed into the domain of self-driving cars. This October, the car was unveiled in the US with LeEco's ambitions in the space being apparent. What people did not